

Business Analyst Course — My Notes

Introduction

- BA role = connects business needs with technical delivery.
- Course roadmap: roles → skills → knowledge areas → tools (Excel) → BA vs Data Analyst.

Why a BA is Needed / BA Roadmap

Why a Business Analyst is Needed

- Projects fail/underdeliver when business needs aren't properly understood or documented.
- Miscommunication between stakeholders and dev/technical teams = root cause of failure.
- BA's job = close that gap — translate business need into something delivery teams can build.

Business Analyst Roadmap

- Foundation: understand business processes + requirements gathering basics.
- Then build practical skills.
- Then tools/certifications to progress in the role.
- Career path is layered, not a single jump.

BA Roles and Responsibilities

- Elicit + document business requirements from stakeholders.
- Analyse "as-is" process → design "to-be" process.
- Bridge communication: business side ↔ technical/delivery side.
- Validate delivered solution actually meets documented requirements.
- Support decisions using data, process models, structured analysis.

Skills Required to Become a BA

- Analytical / critical thinking — break problems down, weigh options.
- Communication + stakeholder management — translate business language ↔ technical language.
- Requirements elicitation + documentation techniques.
- Process modelling / diagramming — flowcharts, process maps.
- Data literacy — spreadsheets, reports, basic data analysis.
- Domain knowledge — understanding the specific industry being analysed.

Business Analysis Knowledge Areas

(Framework mirrors IIBA BABOK)

- Business analysis planning and monitoring
- Elicitation and collaboration
- Requirements life cycle management
- Strategy analysis

- Requirements analysis and design definition
- Solution evaluation

Business Analysis with Excel + Demo

- Organise + clean requirements/process data in spreadsheets.
- Build trackers — requirements log, RAID log, RTM — in Excel.
- Use formulas, pivot tables, charts to summarise findings.
- Present analysis to stakeholders — clear, structured format matters.

BA vs Data Analyst

- BA → focused on business problems, processes, stakeholder needs → turns these into requirements/solutions.
- Data Analyst → focused on collecting/processing/interpreting data → surfaces trends, insights, evidence-based recs.
- Overlap: both may use Excel + data to support decisions.
- Core difference: BA = process/requirements focus. DA = data focus.